

News Weekly

Scientists discover DNA from a woolly rhinoceros in the stomach of a mummified wolf pup.

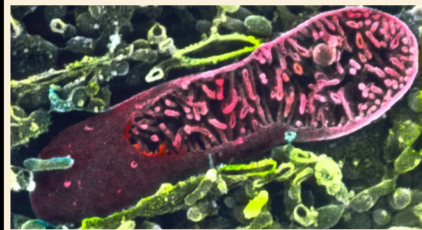
Two ancient wolf pups found entombed in Siberian permafrost more than a decade ago are revealing new stories, thanks to rich DNA clues preserved inside their bodies. In a first, researchers found a chunk of meat from a woolly rhinoceros — a creature similar in size to modern white rhinoceros, but with a shaggy coat of hair — preserved inside the stomach of one of the pups. DNA from that flesh and fur survived beneath the Siberian ice for more than 14,000 years, enabling scientists to sequence the entire genome. They shared their findings in a study published in the journal *Genome Biology and Evolution* on Wednesday.

"This is the first time an entire genome has been reconstructed from an Ice Age animal that was inside another Ice Age animal," said Camilo Chacón-Duque, an author of the study and an evolutionary biologist at Uppsala University in Sweden. "It's a high quality, high resolution genome." (Source: NBC)



Cancer might evade immune defences by stealing mitochondria

A recent study published in "Cell Metabolism" reveals that cancer cells exploit mitochondria derived from immune cells to evade detection and facilitate their spread. Led by Derick Okwan-Duodu at Stanford University, the research examined mitochondrial transfer and found that cancer cells in mice acquired mitochondria from various immune cells uniformly, irrespective of the implantation site. This appropriation compromised the immune cells' functionality while simultaneously activating a beneficial pathway within the cancer cells, thereby enhancing their capacity for immune evasion and aiding in lymph node invasion. Notably, silencing genes associated with this pathway significantly reduced the cancer cells' ability to migrate to lymph nodes. (Source: Nature)



This dinosaur's fossilized claw suggests that it might have snatched eggs rather than insects.

A newly analyzed fossil forelimb and claw from a 67-million-year-old Mongolian dinosaur suggests it may have evolved to steal and eat eggs, classifying it as a new genus and species, *Manipulonyx resbetovi*. The fossil, described as "remarkable" by paleontologist Denver Fowler, represents the most complete arm of these unusual dinosaurs. Researchers used X-ray scans for a 3D rendering of the largest digit. Excavated in 1979 from Mongolia's Gobi Desert, this specimen is part of the alvarezsaurids family, known for their small size and unique features, and had remained largely unexplored in museum archives until recently. (Source: Science News)



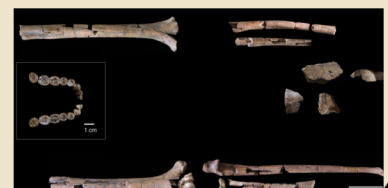
'It's horrifying': Videos of body bags give rare glimpse of Iran's bloody crackdown

A man filming in a forensics warehouse just outside Tehran captures a truly harrowing scene: one body is wrapped in a bloodied shroud, while another lies on the cold floor among numerous others. He describes the situation as akin to "the apocalypse." Iran finds itself largely isolated from the world, as the government has taken the drastic step of cutting off internet access in response to the widespread unrest triggered by the collapse of the national currency and rampant inflation that has gripped the nation. Videos emerging from the country illustrate a violent crackdown, revealing over 200 bodies in a makeshift morgue, and documenting armed confrontations occurring in various cities across the nation. These images paint a chilling picture of the turmoil and desperation faced by the Iranian people during these turbulent times. (Source: NBC)

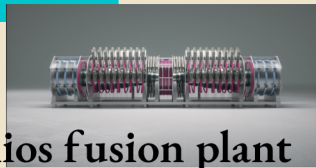


"New Discovery Challenges Long-Held Beliefs About Homo habilis' Place in Human Evolution"

For nearly six decades, *Homo habilis* has been recognized as the earliest member of our genus, *Homo*. This species is distinguished by its flatter face and larger brain relative to earlier hominins, as well as the use of stone tools, which signify a transition toward more human-like characteristics. However, a recent study has uncovered a partial skeleton that exhibits a more primitive body structure. Historically, *Homo habilis* has primarily been identified through teeth and jawbones dating from 2.4 to 1.4 million years ago, leaving much about its lower anatomy a mystery. While it was once considered a direct ancestor of *Homo erectus*, emerging evidence indicates that *Homo habilis* coexisted with other tool-making hominins in the Rift Valley, thereby complicating its evolutionary lineage and timeline.



Can you guess the word in five tries



Thea Energy announces Helios fusion plant design for 390 megawatt output

Thea Energy, Inc. has received certification from the U.S. Department of Energy (DOE) for its “Helios” pilot plant design, marking a significant achievement in the DOE’s Milestone-Based Fusion Development Program. This program has provided \$46 million to support eight private fusion companies. The Helios design was approved after thorough validation of Thea Energy’s system and its deployment path. Since being selected in 2023, Thea Energy has also reached notable milestones, including the world’s first successful superconducting planar coil magnet array.

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Fancy Crêpes

Discover our recipe for exquisite crêpes, a true delight that will tantalize your taste buds. These crêpes, both light and flavorful, strike the perfect balance between simplicity and elegance. Whether you serve them for a gourmet brunch or a sophisticated dessert, they will add a touch of refinement to your table. Get ready to impress your guests with these delicate and delicious crêpes!

- Large, organic free-range eggs — 3 majestic eggs
- All-purpose flour — 1 cup of finely sifted, high-quality flour
- Whole milk — 1 1/2 cups of rich, creamy whole milk
- Butter — 2 tablespoons of golden, melted, unsalted butter
- Vanilla extract — 1 teaspoon of pure, aromatic vanilla essence (optional)
- Granulated sugar — 2 tablespoons of fine, white sugar for a hint of sweetness
- Sea salt — A pinch of delicate sea salt to enhance the flavors
- Nutmeg — A whisper of freshly grated nutmeg for a subtle spice note

1. Crack 3 large, organic free-range eggs into a mixing bowl. Whisk them gently until they are well beaten.
2. Add 1 cup of finely sifted, high-quality all-purpose flour. Gradually incorporate it into the eggs, stirring constantly to prevent lumps from forming.
3. Pour in 1 1/2 cups of rich, creamy whole milk, mixing continuously to create a smooth batter.
4. Melt 2 tablespoons of unsalted butter and incorporate it into the mixture, ensuring it is fully combined.
5. (Optional) Stir in 1 teaspoon of pure, aromatic vanilla extract to add a fragrant touch.
6. Mix in 2 tablespoons of fine, white granulated sugar to sweeten the batter.
7. Sprinkle a pinch of delicate sea salt to enhance the flavors and balance the sweetness.
8. Grate a whisper of fresh nutmeg over the mixture for a subtle spice note. Stir everything together until the batter is smooth and well combined.
9. Preheat a non-stick frying pan over medium heat. Lightly grease it with a bit of butter or oil.
10. Pour a small ladleful of batter into the pan, swirling it around to form a thin, even layer.
11. Cook for about 1-2 minutes, or until the edges start to lift and the bottom is golden brown. Flip the crepe and cook the other side for another minute.
12. Repeat with the remaining batter, keeping the cooked crepes warm in a low oven if necessary.
13. Serve the crepes with your choice of toppings, such as fresh fruits, a sprinkle of powdered sugar, or a drizzle of maple syrup. Enjoy!



Preppy Kitchen



Curious about this recipe’s origins? Simply zap that QR code!